

ABSTRACT

An analysis of factors that influence the legislative initiative bill according to the characteristics of the legislation

- Focusing on Standing Committees in the 19th National Assembly -

Lee, Ji Hyung

Department of Public Administration

Graduate School of Governance

Sungkyunkwan University

In this study, an analysis of the influence factor of a legislative bill approval at the Standing Committee level was made with 2,073 bill proposals passed in the 19th National Assembly (May 30, 2012 to May 29, 2016) from the Science, ICT and Future Planning Korea Communications Commission, National Defense Committee, and Agriculture, Food, Rural Affairs, Oceans and Fisheries Committee. The individual characteristics factor and the bill characteristics factor of the Chief author of the bill was divided to compare/analyze and interpret the significance.

Specifically, as individual characteristics factor of the Chief author of the bill, the seniority, party, elected form, number of joint submitted member, career of a legal profession, job and career connection with relevant Standing Committee, and the National Assembly member's frequency of exposure to the press/media were considered.

Second, as bill characteristics factor, the issue intensity of the bill—taking into account the frequency of exposure to the press/media—, the accompanying

of the budget, and the measure in dispute was considered. Also, to measure the impact of press and media on the member individual and the bill, the report number was measured by searching the Naver news; the factors that affect the legislative bill approval along with its leverage were statistically investigated through a logistic regression analysis.

As a result of the analysis, the following factors were shown to have a positive influence on the legislative bill approval: in the individual characteristics factor of the Chief author of the bill, the seniority, elected form, number of joint submitted member; in the bill characteristics factor, the issue intensity of the bill, the accompanying of the budget, and the measure in dispute; and the 2013 year variable number which is a control variable. The individual member's frequency of exposure to the press/media as well as the 2015 year variable number which is the control variable, however, showed the opposite result. Meanwhile, the party, career of a legal profession, and job and career connection with relevant Standing Committee of the Chief author of the bill was verified not to have a significant effect on the bill's approval.

As mentioned above, as a study that focused on the possibility of a legislative bill approval in the 19th National Assembly Standing Committee level, it is anticipated that the study has a distinction with other existing studies and can contribute to the theoretical aspect in a great extent. First, the factors that affect the bill approval are significant in that they are being reviewed in a variety of way and in detail. Second, in analyzing the affecting factors of the bill approval, this study focuses on the possibility of the approval of the Standing Committee, which plays a central role in the coordination of opinions over the bill and the legislative process. Third, to explore the possibility of a legislative bill approval in the Standing Committee level, the impact of the press and media on the bill approval in the policy decision process of the National Assembly was reviewed by investigating the impact of the press and media on National Assembly members and the bill.

The limitations of this study, despite providing the above-mentioned

theoretical discussions and policy implications, are considered as follows, with subsequent supplementation in demand:

First, the analysis subjects of this study were limited to three Standing Committees from the 19th National Assembly, having a critical point of generalization. Therefore, it is required, in the subsequent studies, to further expand the term range or analysis subjects as well as elaborate the review of the theoretical concept accordance, in the aspect of the variable validity through massive data/reference.

Second, in verifying the influence of the press/media on National Assembly members and the bill, I was able to grasp only the general tendency of the issue size—big and small—focusing simply on the related news media or daily newspaper's coverage number and not their covering attitude or decision-making relevance due to the extensive and broad coverage of the articles. Therefore, it is demanded of the subsequent studies to investigate the article contents more specifically by classifying the coverage amount into positive and negative categories to reveal the relevance of policy decision process and the press/media, hence analyze the direction of the public opinion and the press.

Keywords: Standing Committee, legislative bill proposal, (legislative) bill approval, 19th National Assembly, press and media